

PROBLEM AREAS OF READING

Description of difficulty	Tips and tricks for dealing with the difficulty
Area „Content“	
The text is very theoretical; no examples are given. How am I supposed to understand this?	In some disciplines examples are rarely used. It helps to think of some examples yourself.
I cannot clearly identify the position of the author.	Try to find linguistic markers in the text. This includes: Using the first person (me, us, the author...) Impersonal phrases: one could say..., it becomes evident that... TIP: Moll, Melanie / Thielmann, Winfried (2017): Wissenschaftliches Deutsch. Wie es geht und worauf es dabei ankommt. Konstanz: UVK Verlagsgesellschaft mbH [Studieren, aber richtig]
The author's position should be different from the positions they are citing, right? But I can't really recognize that.	A bibliographical reference follows a sentence. This is a reproduction of content from the text (as paraphrase or indirect quotation). The author position is then often "hidden" in a verb or an adverb.
I have the impression that I am missing context.	As long as you know little about a field, this feeling is completely normal. TIP: Read other texts from the particular field/seminar/teaching material.
I'm not familiar with the people being cited.	Search e.g. in Wikipedia for a short introductory explanation to get an idea of why the citation might be relevant (perhaps there is even a video). Keep in mind that this is NOT enough for in depth representation in your own texts.
I'm not familiar with the texts/debates/terms that are being referenced.	Search e.g. in Wikipedia for a short introductory explanation to get started (perhaps there is even a video). Keep in mind that this is NOT enough for in depth representation in your own texts.
There are a lot of tables and figures in the text which I do not understand and/or whose connection to the text is not clear to me.	Usually, figures/tables are explained in more detail in the text. However, it also possible that you are missing certain expertise. In this case further research or explanations by the lecturers are required.
The text refers to things I am unfamiliar with. I am probably missing some background knowledge/information.	Use subject-specific handbooks/manuals
The text keeps referencing other texts and I don't know any of them!	Search e.g. in Wikipedia for a short introductory explanation to get started (perhaps there is even a video). Keep in mind that this is NOT enough for in depth representation in your own texts.

Area „Language“	
The text consists mainly of nouns, which is difficult to read.	This is completely normal. It requires some familiarization with the technical language. Tip: If terms occur frequently, it is worthwhile to create a separate dictionary for them.
	Developing an understanding of these networks is a task you will have to face during your studies.
	Science works with many networks of ideas, terms and concepts. Consider creating your own <i>concept maps</i> .
	Use subject-specific handbooks/manuals
The text is very abstract/complex/theoretical.	Try to express what the text is about in your own words.
The text sounds very „pompous“, „funny“, „strange“.	This is "everyday scientific language". It encompasses everything that is written in between the technical terms. Since in science a lot of information has to be presented using very little space, there are many nominalizations in German as well as English. Verbs often convey the author's own reception and position. Therefore, it is useful to pay attention to the verbs in texts.
	There are also many standardized phrases in scientific texts, see Phrasebank for English, http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk ; for German see Graefen, Gabriele/ Moll, Melanie (2011): Wissenschaftssprache Deutsch: lesen – verstehen – schreiben. Ein Lehr- und Arbeitsbuch. Frankfurt/Main u. a.: Lang
The language in which the text is written is very difficult for me to understand. There are many words that I don't know.	Look up keywords, i.e. the words that appear/are highlighted several times in the text. DO NOT look up every word you do not know.
	Use digital reference tools. Find advice at: www.leuphana.de/schreibzentrum > Writing Resources
	Do you want to work on your language skills through this specific reading task? At the Sprachenzentrum/language center you have the possibility to learn by yourself and/or take courses.
I do not understand the terms and concepts used in the text.	This is completely normal. It requires some familiarization with the technical language. Tip: If terms occur frequently, it is worthwhile to create a separate dictionary for them.
	Developing an understanding of these networks is a task you will have to face during your studies.
	Science works with many networks of ideas, terms and concepts. Consider creating your own <i>concept maps</i> .
	Use subject-specific handbooks/manuals
Area „Text“	
The text is too long to be easily read.	Observe for how long you can read with concentration by taking the time once. Identify reading characteristics: Reading places (where do you read?), media (in which

	media do you read?), when do you read (times)? → Remember: Reading scientific texts is exhausting.
The text is too complex. I don't understand it!	It helps to read section by section and to summarize each paragraph in a keyword or a sentence.
	If the text is read by several people (e.g. because it is discussed in the seminar): Form a discussion group and talk about the text. Some questions are easier to answer together than alone.
I can't follow the structure of the text.	Create a <i>reverse outline</i> on an extra sheet of paper, i.e. write for each paragraph: "This paragraph is about X". See: Cf. https://writing.wisc.edu/handbook/process/reverseoutlines/
I find it difficult to understand the text's line of argumentation.	It helps to summarize core statements/individual passages in your own words.
	Texts are written discussions. The texts that are being referenced are the "discussion partners". These discussion partners are introduced through citations. TIP: Graff, Gerald/ Birkenstein, Cathy (2010): They say / I say. The moves that matter in academic writing. New York, London: W.W. Norton & Co. Die „Redlichkeit“ in der Wissenschaft schreibt es deshalb vor, diese zu nennen. Vgl. „Gute wissenschaftliche Praxis“ (Gazette 10, 2009); Handout „Zitierst du noch oder plagierst du schon“.
	Try to identify linguistic markers of the argumentation. Find an overview here: Moll, Melanie and Thielmann, Winfried (2017), Wissenschaftliches Deutsch. Wie es geht und worauf es dabei ankommt (Studieren, aber richtig; UVK Verlagsgesellschaft mbH: Konstanz).
I don't understand the footnotes (why is there sometimes more text in the footnotes than in the actual text?).	The meaning and use of footnotes differ in the various scientific disciplines. In some discourses, footnotes are primarily used to indicate source references (citation in footnotes). In principle, the main statements are in the main text, which is why it makes sense to concentrate on reading the main text. In addition to the source references, footnotes are used, for example, to define terms, to provide explanations and information that go beyond the text or to give scientific proof. To gain certainty about how footnotes are used in texts, it is therefore necessary to view several texts from the scientific area. This will become clearer in the course of your studies.
Ich verstehe die Funktion der Klammern und Fuß- und Endnoten (Verweise) nicht.	Die Form, wie diese Verweise in den Text integriert werden, sind fachspezifisch. Es gibt verschiedene Konventionen. Unterschieden werden 3 Systeme: Autor-Jahr-, Fußnoten-, Nummernsystem. Vgl. Handout „Richtig Zitieren. Formen und Funktionen“
	Erstelle ein <i>reverse outline</i> auf einem extra Blatt, d.h. schreibe für jeden Absatz: „In diesem Absatz geht es um X“. Vgl. https://writing.wisc.edu/handbook/process/reverseoutlines/
Ich verstehe irgendwie gar nichts.	Prüfe, ob du die Ursache näher bestimmen kannst: Liegt es evtl. an Genre, Konvention, fehlendes Hintergrundwissen etc.

Mir scheint jeder Satz wichtig zu sein.	Versuche, den Text erst einmal zu überfliegen, konzentriere dich auf die Einleitung und den Schluss. Versuche, dort Schlüsselstellen zu identifizieren und Schwerpunkte zu setzen. Nutze die Hilfen, die die Autoren den Lesenden geben, wenn sie bspw. erklären, was sie im Text tun werden. Versuche, Thesen von Beispielen und Belegen zu trennen.
Muss ich alle Texte, auf die Bezug genommen wird, auch lesen?	Nein, aber ... 1) Ein Text sollte alle Informationen für den Lesenden zur Verfügung stellen, die es braucht, um den Text zu verstehen – auch ohne in die anderen Fachtexte gelesen zu haben. 2) „Alle“ Fachtexte zu lesen, ist aus zeitlichen Gründen unmöglich. ABER: Notwendig ist es, a) wenn ich den Text ohne den Rückgriff auf das, worauf er beruht, nicht verstehen kann; b) wenn ich in meiner eigenen Textproduktion Inhalte benutzen möchte, die in dem gelesenen Text referiert werden. Es gilt das Prinzip, dass man die Originalquelle nutzen sollte (und nicht „zitiert nach...“ verwendet).
Was ist das für eine Art von Text?	Viele wissenschaftliche Texte sind argumentativ aufgebaut. Hierzu zählen die meisten Artikel (in Zeitschriften, Sammelbänden) und Essays. Darüber hinaus gibt es noch deskriptive Texte (Berichte, Reports, Protokolle) und instruktive Texte (Anleitungen). Langfristig gesehen nutzt Genre-Wissen bei der Konkretisierung von Leseerwartungen und Suchstrategien.